

Ramsay council briefs

The following items were among the business conducted by Ramsay Township council at the last regular meeting, Oct. 2. In the absence of reeve Margaret Duncan, deputy-reeve Jim Lowry was elected to chair the meeting.

Road tour coming up

The council will tour township roads Oct. 25 with road superintendent Bill Drummond.

Discussion of recycling depot

Dr. Drummond informed council nine roll-off bins had been filled during a recycling depot held Sept. 29 at the township garage and suggested similar events be held more often. He added there were close to 25 cars at a time at the garage Saturday morning and that he had to open the garage's back gate to let the traffic out. Mr. Lowry said he was impressed with the small amount of non-recyclable waste that was brought out in hopes that it too could be recycled.

Tires accepted at dump?

The Public Works Committee was asked to discuss a policy for allowing tires into the township dump, following discussion on that matter. Mr. Drummond reported the Ministry of the Environment told him the landfill site can accept tires, and council discussed setting a fee per tire left at the dump, since they must be buried.

Preparations to close road

Clerk-treasurer Ross Trimble was instructed to prepare a bylaw to officially close an untravelled part of a road that runs across part of lot 12, concession nine.

Art and environmental consciousness combine through the eyes and works of artist Juan Geuer

By John LeVatte
Gazette reporter

For Juan Geuer, art has no definition or simplified meaning.

Instead, Geuer says art is unique and that if it is good, it speaks for itself.

Now, after a lifetime of working with scientifically-inspired exhibits shown throughout the world, Geuer is hoping his art is speaking louder than ever to those who view it.

His latest creation on view at the National Gallery of Canada in Ottawa is entitled *Karonhia* and uses a total of eight suspended rectangular mirrors hung from the gallery ceiling.

By looking into the mirrors, Geuer says one is shown a constantly changing picture of the sky overhead which is the main idea behind the exhibit.

"I am simply trying to put people in touch with what's already out there," says Geuer.

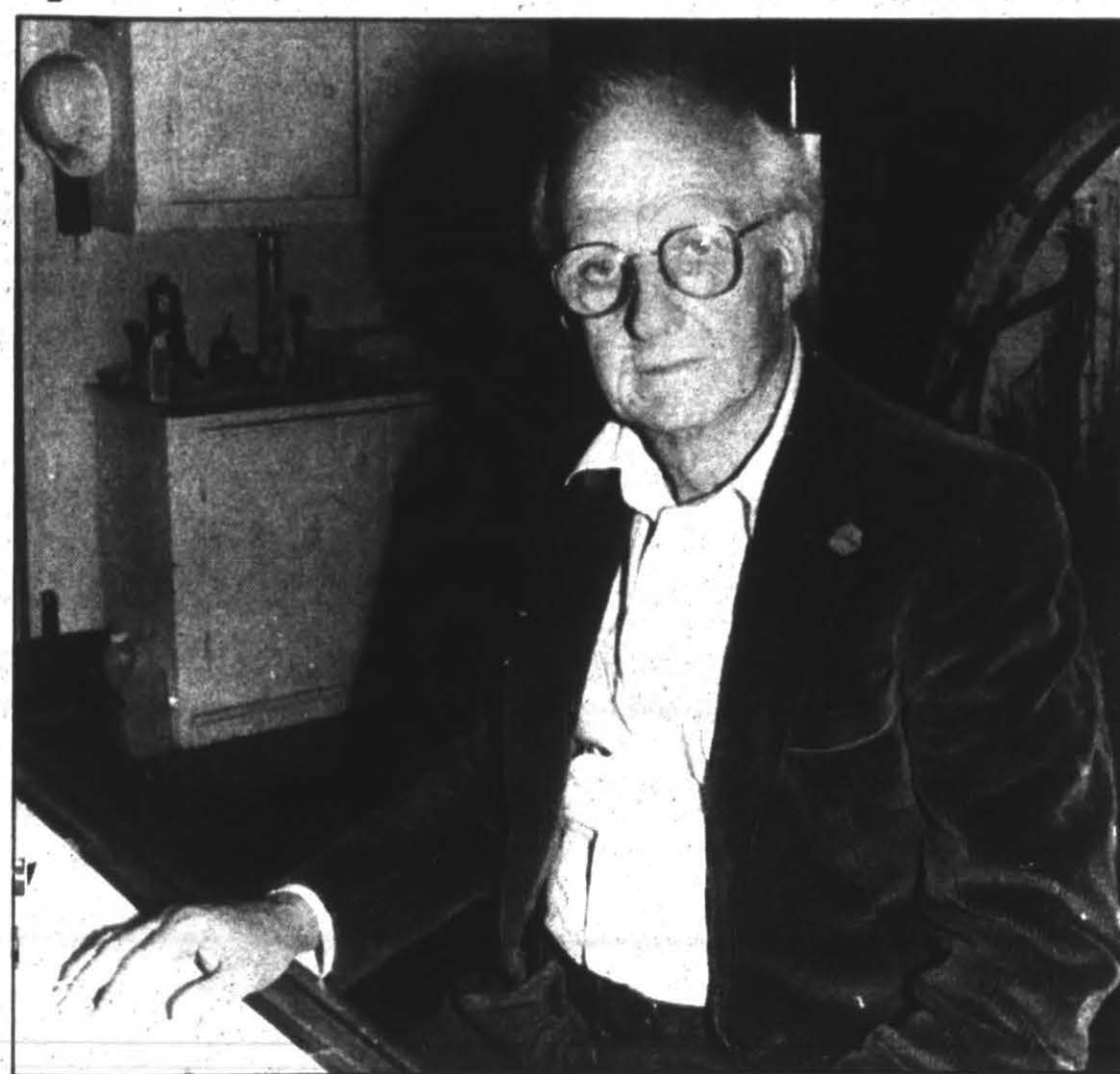
Most people have looked into the sky and noticed strange and peculiar cloud formations, or light changes during a moment spent with nature says Geuer. It is these moments he is trying to capture with his exhibit.

"We are basically bringing the sky into the gallery."

Geuer has had several exhibits at the National Gallery. His last work, *The People Participating Seismometer*, gave visitors a glimpse at rarely seen earth tremors.

The exhibit worked through a moving beam of laser light which registered and displayed minute tremors which travel continuously beneath the earth's surface. It also registered seismic activity emanating from the footsteps of onlookers.

Most of the Almonte resident's works are inspired from a deep concern and



Almonte artist Juan Geuer at home in the studio where he has created many nationally and internationally renowned works of art-science. Geuer's latest work entitled *"Karonhia"* is currently on display at the National Gallery of Canada in Ottawa.

love for the planet we inhabit.

Geuer says he must have a purpose behind his works and with *Karonhia* his purpose was clear from the beginning.

Geuer sent a letter to the curator of the National Gallery complete with sketches of his idea, for a gallery "should be an observatory."

"I told her that now that we have done

what we've done to our planet and that it is under stresses and strains that may soon make it incapable of sustaining human life, we should look at the art around us."

The gallery immediately accepted the "challenge" according to Geuer, who set to work on the details of the exhibit.

After overcoming some significant

design obstacles the installation was ready for the viewing public who, says Geuer, see a kaleidoscope of color matched with mostly unnoticed natural beauty of the sky.

He says the sky will sometimes be a deep blue color and then other times be a combination of blue-green, or blue-purple.

Other times the artist says the mirrors simply reflect a sky which is in need of help.

"Sometimes you see a horrible grey sky and it makes you aware that something bad is going on."

At this point in his career, Geuer says he acts simply as the mediator between the earth and his gallery viewers.

"When doing these types of exhibits the artist becomes much less important and is basically the intermediary for the person viewing the work and the earth."

In today's society Geuer says people are sometimes too interested in what people do and think and not what is going on around them.

"We must start to look at the earth and listen to what she wants to tell us," he said.

Now entering the later years of his life, Geuer, 73, seems to have no intention of slowing down his incredible pace of creation.

In fact, his next odyssey will take him to his native Holland for a group project which will look at geographical "character" of the area in and around the city of Limburg.

And how does he find the energy to complete the time-consuming and often mind-bending works?

"You have to have a purpose in life. If you feel you have a purpose you keep going."

L & R Scottish Regiment spreads its wings to Almonte and Carleton Place

By Ryland Coyne

Special to the Canadian

A Scottish regiment with a long history in Lanark County is spreading its wings. The Pembroke-based Lanark and Renfrew Scottish (L & R for short) has been given permission to expand its operations to include a unit from Almonte and Carleton Place.

Recruiting officer Capt. Roger Martin was in both communities last week in an effort to drum up interest at the local high schools. He said he's "looking for 20 to 25" young people aged 17 years or over to get the unit started.

As tentative students approached his display near the ADHS cafeteria Friday, Capt. Martin delivered his best pitch. And to many, it sounded pretty good.

"All it takes is one night a week (on parade in Carleton Place) and one weekend a month (usually at Canadian Forces Base Petawawa)," he told potential recruits. "We'll provide everything, uniforms, transportation, meals. All you have to do is make your way to the Legion in Carleton Place."

And then he'd add the coup de grace.

"It's really a glorified part-time job. It works out to about \$7 per hour," he told one eager student. "You can make \$2,000 to \$3,000 in your spare time by next summer depending on how much time you put in."

"And there's no commitment. You can quit at any time."

Besides the age requirement, a reservist must also have a Grade 10 education and be medically fit.

During the initial training period, Capt. Martin said newcomers would be taught such things as military discipline, dress and deportment, military law, as well as other basic military training. By next summer, he said he could "almost guarantee" each one either a summer job or trades training at one of several locations in Ontario.



Lanark and Renfrew Scottish Regiment recruiting officer Capt. Roger Martin discusses the L & R expansion plans with a potential recruit at Almonte high school.

Upon successful completion of basic training, the reservist can then move on to trades training in the area of his or her choice from finance clerk to infantry. "It's great for the kids, for career advancement," said Capt. Martin.

While Capt. Martin wasn't able to attain his recruitment goal on this first journey to the Mississippi Valley, he said he was pleased with the 10 or 15 recruits he was able to attract.

He also said his trip to this area was an educational experience.

"I found out the L & R has been around for 120 years. When I was walking down the street, some people recognized the uniform and were telling that their father or uncle or grandfather had been in the regiment. Now, we've come back to re-establish the ties we had with the com-

munity," he said.

The Lanark and Renfrew regiment is approximately 120 strong incorporating an area that includes Chalk River, Deep River, Arnprior, and Renfrew. It is now looking to increase that number by 75 or 80 in the near future.

Capt. Martin said he's found a number of ex-servicemen are "looking to get back into the reserves", particularly with the uncertain economic conditions looming on the horizon.

He added that while much of the recruiting is done in the high schools, he's also looking for local residents who have had Canadian Forces service within the past five years.

Anyone interested in joining the L & R is asked to contact Capt. Martin in Pembroke at 588-6166.

Leo Jordan named Tory Energy Critic

Newly-elected Lanark-Renfrew MPP Leo Jordan has been appointed as Progressive Conservative Party Critic for the Ministry of Energy, party leader Mike Harris has announced.

"I am confident that Leo will bring the expertise and enthusiasm that he displayed during his successful election campaign to his portfolio," says Harris. "I look forward to working with Leo as we tackle the very serious challenges facing Ontario under an NDP government."

The Lanark-Renfrew MPP says with 39 years of experience at Ontario Hydro, he has a solid background in the energy field and is well suited to handle his new responsibility as the ministry's PC critic.

"I am looking forward to working with them to solve the problems that need to be dealt with..."

--Leo Jordan



Jordan, sworn in for his first term as MPP for Lanark-Renfrew on Sept. 28, says he's looking forward to the challenges of the coming parliamentary session with a great deal of "interest and enthusiasm."

Having taken part in the ploughing

competition for MPPs at the International Ploughing Match, and through orientation and other social events at Queen's Park during September, Jordan has already met many of the NDP members who have now become cabinet ministers.

"I am looking forward to working with them to solve the problems that need to be dealt with in Lanark-Renfrew," says Jordan. "I will also enjoy debating the issues when they introduce - or fail to introduce - required legislation."

Jordan says he has a "fairly long list" of local priorities, such as the Rideau Regional Centre, plant closings, water and sewer systems, health care and transportation needs, that he will be raising in the legislature.

Tax inequities could soon be a thing of the past commissioner tells Pakenham council

By Donna Quartermain

Some inequities that have crept into the tax system in Pakenham Township could soon be resolved.

A request from Lanark County Council for a county-wide assessment could be forthcoming as early as 1991, while Pakenham's similar request was put on hold pending county council's approval.

Jim Edmunds, commissioner of the Brockville Assessment office, told council last Tuesday that county council passed a resolution in 1988 to have the Ministry of Revenue undertake a county-wide assessment at the market value base year of 1988.

"We are still under that direction and with the appointment of a new government we can only assume the commitment is still there," said Mr. Edmunds. "We are still waiting for direction under the new minister."

The request by county council will include equalization among all property values including farm, commercial, in-

dustrial and railway. Mr. Edmunds said a property valued at \$50,000, whether in Pakenham or Almonte, would have exactly the same assessment throughout the county.

"Under that system, property of equal value will pay the same proportion of

crease will only be paying their fair share."

Within the last two years, there has been an inspection process in the township, said Mr. Edmunds, to visit all properties to ensure records are updated.

When questioned by reeve Harry Barr

"...the inequities that have crept into the system during the past 40 years will be rectified."

--Jim Edmunds

school tax and property tax within the county," Mr. Edmunds explained.

Mr. Edmunds said that because Pakenham hasn't been subject to a reassessment since 1950, they can expect some tax shifts.

"You are going from a 1950 tax base of assessment to 1988--the inequities that have crept into the system during the past 40 years will be rectified," Mr. Edmunds said. "The people who do have an in-

as to when county council could expect a final presentation, Mr. Edmunds estimated late in 1990.

"December would be a potential date, once all values are arrived at, it's in place very quickly," he explained.

If county council rejects the proposal, Mr. Edmunds said, they revert back to the previous system. He said the stamp of approval has to come from the majority of county council and the majority of local councils.

Protect heritage through communication

Being alone for extended periods of time is a somewhat unnerving prospect for most of us. Pardon my introspection, but that's how I'm feeling right about now.

It's late and the meeting's over. The ceiling fans in the Old Post Office are whirling overhead, and they seem uncommonly loud as the street noises end for another day. I'd rather be home beside the warmth of the stove, enjoying the evening's final cup of tea. When those feelings start to creep in its heartening to think of those around you who can share ideas and thoughts with and to use that encouragement to get on with life.

Individuals gain and grow from these kinds of exchanges. So do organizations, trades, professions, communities, and so on regions.

Take Lanark County for example. Lanark has four sister regions across Canada partaking in a similar national experiment entitled the Heritage Regions programme. That's not a lot, but it's a start. Thirty other regions have expressed an interest in par-



By Jim Mountain



ticipating in the programme as well.

Heritage Canada is the national non-profit organization that has raised the money to undertake these ventures assisted by private and public sector partners, and regional organizations. (It's a different combination in each province) Lanark is connected to the Cowichan-Chemainus Valleys on Vancouver Island, B.C., Manitoulin Island, Ontario, the Centre Sud area in Montreal, and as of last week, the Labrador Straits Region of New-

foundland - Labrador.

All of these projects have a common mandate of protecting, enhancing and promoting their region's heritage, which broadly defined, includes the natural, built and cultural assets of the area.

Each project has a local office and a coordinator who works long and hard at economic and cultural development ventures that make the region a more viable, enjoyable place to live.

So far the exchanges between these participating regions have been minimal and low key. That will change this year, for a concerted effort will be made to bring people to Lanark, and Lanark County people out to places like the beautiful Cowichan Valley or the rugged shores of the Labrador Straits.

Why do this? Certainly there are practical lessons to be learned and shared from region to region. But there's more to it than that. Think about the last six months in Canada. Our national fibre has been put to the test, and has become somewhat un-

ravelled in the process. Exchanges between Canadians can help increase our understanding of each other. And at a time like this in our history, that's important.

Take Manitoulin Island for example. On the Saturday of Thanksgiving weekend, the Island's residents represented by their mayor, reeves, and band chiefs will be signing the first ever Friendship Treaty between native and non-native people. A recent issue of the Manitoulin Express credited the Heritage Regions project with bringing this about. These two cultures have shared the same island since the mid 19th century and never worked together. Now after Oka, the people of Manitoulin see that the key to their economic and cultural development is simply listening and respecting each other. There's a lesson there for all of us.

If you're interested in learning more about the Lanark project, contact me at 256-1978 or write to Box 668, Almonte, KOA 1A0. Better yet, drop in to the Old Post Office on 73 Mill Street.

From page 1

Reunion

ment in particular was hard to swallow. "The one comment that Rick Lotan is taller than me when he always wanted me

as someone to look up to," said Currie.

Coach Currie said he will continue to coach the senior Thunderbolts hoping to surpass the record of Amos Alonzo Stagg of Longbeach University in California.

"He coached until he was 96."

From page 1

Light

tion for local merchants and invited guests at the town hall auditorium. An hour later, a procession will travel down Mill Street from the library, featuring the mysterious Queen of Light and six little "sparkle fairies" in a coach. At the end of the trail, the Queen and Mayor Dorothy Finner will utter the magic words to light up the main street.

From then on, festivities become more casual, with caroling by the Almonte Centennial Choir in the Old Post Office, and Christmas treats such as hot cider, hot chocolate and warmed chestnuts offered by the Lions' Club, the textile

museum and other groups.

Santa Claus will be flown in from the North Pole to take requests in the Old Post Office Saturday from 10 a.m. to noon, then 2 p.m. to 4 p.m. and again Sunday from 2 p.m. to 4 p.m. Parents may also buy photos of their child(ren) with Santa, taken by photographers Stan Madore and Paddy Thomas.

Fun on the streets will continue with caroling, clowns and more hot drinks all day Saturday and Sunday afternoon.

The final event of the weekend will be a family turkey supper served up by the Legion Ladies Auxiliary 6 p.m. Sunday. Tickets must be purchased in advance, and are available at the Legion, Morton's Variety, Mesmeralda's and the Almonte Pharmacy.

Please give the Gazette 24 hours notice of your event